



resources, stunning landscapes, and a famously tolerant, law-abiding society, for example, it offers one of the highest standards of living anywhere in the world. Canada was first colonized in the 17th and 18th centuries by

France and Britain. While both influences are still obvious, modern Canada (a parliamentary democracy) is a member of the British Commonwealth, with Queen Elizabeth II as its head of state.

GROWTH INDUSTRY

Lumber is one of Canada's most important natural resources; for the western province of British Columbia, lumber (and related trades like the pulp-and-paper business) constitutes the main industry.



1 Tree felling

On Lyell Island, in BC's Queen Charlotte group, a logger cuts down a large tree. Evergreen trees from British Columbia make up about half of all Canada's timber.



2 Water ride

Felled logs are usually transported to the lumber or paper mill by water. Here, the driver of a "winder boat" rounds up loose logs on their way for processing.



3 Cutting up

Instead of being transported to a mill, cut tree trunks are sometimes trimmed into posts or planks on a portable sawmill taken to the forestry site.

The central motif on the Canadian flag is a maple leaf, the country's official symbol.



PAY TO VIEW

Canada's scenic beauty attracts thousands of tourists from all over the world. Here, visitors to Grouse Mountain near Vancouver take advantage of the spectacular views available from a cable car that skims the treetops.

ROYAL CANADIAN MOUNTED POLICE

Originally based in northwestern Canada (and called Northwest Mounted Police), this famous force gained its Royal Charter in 1904. In 1920, their responsibilities were expanded to include the enforcement of federal laws countrywide, and they became the RCMP. Today, the familiar uniform is purely ceremonial.

MUSICAL RIDE

Developed by early Mounties to amuse themselves and show off their riding skills to the community, the RCMP Musical Ride is based on cavalry drills. This theatrical display is performed across the country during the summer months.

